Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Product Vision Statement

Many CRM providers offer a wide range of features that make sense for enterprises but not for small and medium businesses (SMBs). SMBs need less customization and more of a point solution. Our CRM will be built specifically for small businesses and tailored to their vertical and market size, making it quick and easy to use. Features and add-ons, such as telephony, email, SMS, calendar, and AI tools, can be added as needed.

OLD:

We will unify CRM and Unified Communications into a single platform where every customer interaction is captured, contextualized, and logged automatically as it happens. AI closes the gap that used to require manual effort: surfacing the right customer context before an agent even answers, and turning the conversation itself into a secure, structured record without anyone needing to type it in. By collapsing the artificial line between "front office" (engaging the customer) and "back office" (recording what occurred), we give every user one system to work in and one trustworthy source of truth for what happened by design, not by discipline.

Problem Context

Small and medium businesses (SMBs) depend on CRMs to track leads, manage customer relationships, and follow up consistently. Most CRM products, however, are designed around enterprise needs: complex data models, deep customization, role hierarchies, and long implementations that usually involve an admin or consultant. SMBs rarely have the staff, budget, or time to configure and maintain a system like that.

As a result, SMBs tend to run into the same problems:

- **Too much complexity.** They pay for features they never use, and the ones they do need are buried in menus and settings.
- **Heavy setup.** Customizing fields, pipelines, and workflows to fit their business takes time and technical skill they don’t have, so many teams never finish setup or abandon the tool.

- **Generic fit.** A one-size-fits-all CRM doesn't reflect how a specific vertical works. A home services company, a real estate office, and a medical practice have different workflows, terminology, and data, yet they are given the same generic structure.
- **Fragmented communication.** Calls, email, text messages, and calendar events live in separate tools, so customer history is incomplete and follow-ups are missed.
- **Low adoption.** When a CRM is slow or hard to use, employees skip it or fall back on spreadsheets, inboxes, and memory, which defeats its purpose.

OLD:

Today, customer-facing teams operate across two disconnected systems: a CRM that stores customer records and a separate Unified Communications (UC) platform that handles the actual conversation. Users toggle between tools mid-interaction, customer context arrives late or incomplete, and activity logging depends on manual entry that is inconsistent, error-prone, and difficult to audit. The result is slower resolution, inconsistent customer experience, and compliance exposure wherever a human forgets to log what happened.

Key Hypothesis

We believe that SMBs will adopt and keep using a CRM that is tailored to their vertical and market size, and that works well out of the box with minimal setup, more than a general-purpose, highly customizable CRM. We will know this is true if new customers reach their first meaningful use quickly and keep using the product at higher rates than they do with the alternatives.

Supporting hypotheses

1. **Simplicity drives adoption.** If we remove enterprise-grade complexity and customization, then SMB users will complete setup and log activity regularly, because the product asks less of them.
2. **Vertical defaults reduce setup effort.** If we ship pre-built pipelines, fields, terminology, and workflows for specific verticals, then customers will need far less configuration than with a generic CRM.
3. **Modular add-ons match how SMBs buy.** If core CRM is simple and telephony, email, SMS, calendar, and AI tools are optional add-ons, then customers will start small and expand, because they pay only for what they need.

4. **Unified communications improve follow-up.** If calls, emails, and texts are logged automatically on the customer record, then teams will miss fewer follow-ups and have a more complete customer history.

5. **AI reduces manual work.** If AI tools handle tasks such as summarizing conversations, drafting replies, and suggesting next steps, then users will spend less time on data entry and be more likely to keep records current.

6. **SMBs will pay for a focused product.** If the product is priced simply and fits their size, then SMBs will prefer it to enterprise CRMs they under-use or to spreadsheets.

OLD:

We believe that merging CRM and unified comms into a single workspace, and using AI to automatically surface customer context before interactions and convert their conversations into structured records afterward, then associates will spend significantly less time on manual data entry and tool-switching. As such, customers will no longer have to repeat their history, and managers can gain a comprehensive view of team activity without micromanaging. Because logging would occur by default, record completeness and compliance would improve at the same rate as productivity.

Success Metrics

Small businesses can start using the CRM quickly, keep using it, and find it simple and reliable.

Product

- **Easy to set up:** at least 70% of new users finish setup within 1 day.
- **Quick to get value:** a new user can add their first contact in under 15 minutes.
- **People keep using it:** at least 85% of customers are still active after 3 months.
- **Add-ons are useful:** at least 30% of customers use at least one add-on (telephony, email, SMS, calendar, or AI).

Technical

- **Fast:** pages load in under 2 seconds.
- **Reliable:** the system is available 99.9% of the time.
- **Accurate:** calls, emails, and texts are saved to the right customer record at least 99% of the time.

OLD:

Reduce the time associates spend on post-interaction note-taking and data entry by at least 30%, and cut average handling time by 15-20%. We aim to reach for 90% or more of calls and meetings automatically captured, transcribed, and logged to the correct customer record.

Personas

Customer (homeowner or small business owner)
Books seasonal services and requests repairs. *Needs:* Easy scheduling and reminders, quick answers without repeating their service history, and clear updates on appointment times, quotes, and completed work.

Office Associate / Dispatcher
Handles calls, texts, and bookings, and schedules crews. *Needs:* A simple interface that shows a customer's past visits, equipment, and notes in one place, with calls and messages saved automatically and workflows that handle reminders and follow-ups.

Technician / Crew Member
Performs HVAC service, lawn care, or garage door repairs on site. *Needs:* Quick phone access to job details, customer history, and past repairs, plus an easy way to add notes and photos and mark jobs complete.

Owner / Manager
Oversees the business and the team. *Needs:* A quick view of upcoming jobs, seasonal demand across all three services, crew workload, and customer follow-ups, without micromanaging.

OLD:

- Customer: An external client or contact, interacting with other people via scheduled meetings. Needs: Quick resolutions without having to repeat their

history every time they speak to a new representative. They need easy access to their shared records and transparent communication.

- Associates/Users: Day-to-day user, handling high volumes of calls, meetings, and other communications with customers and team members. Needs: Easy, simple interface that allows them to have meetings/notes easily transcribed, records saved and stored properly, and built-in workflows.
- Managers/Leads: Administrative user who oversees team performance, assignments, and customer communication quality. Needs: Easy, simple interface allowing them to swiftly access performance analytics, meeting notes, and transcriptions, and team-wide activity oversight without the need to micromanage.

Use Cases

Use Case 1: Seasonal HVAC tune-up booking
Personas: Customer, Office Associate

In early spring, the CRM texts customers who had an AC or furnace service last year and offers to book their annual tune-up. A customer replies asking for Saturday. The associate sees the reply in the customer's record, checks the calendar, and confirms the appointment. The customer gets a reminder the day before, and no one has to make calls to track people down.

Use Case 2: Garage door repair call
Personas: Customer, Office Associate, Technician

A customer calls because their garage door won't close. The associate opens the record and sees the door model and the previous spring replacement, so the customer doesn't have to explain the history. The associate schedules a same-day visit and assigns a technician. The technician sees the details on their phone, completes the repair, and adds notes and photos. The customer receives a message when the work is done.

Use Case 3: Lawn care recurring service
Personas: Customer, Office Associate

A customer signs up for weekly mowing from April to October. The associate sets up the recurring schedule in the CRM. Each week, the customer receives a visit reminder, and if rain forces a reschedule, the associate sends one message to all affected customers. At the end of the season, the CRM offers fall cleanup and next year's plan.

Use Case 4: Owner plans for the busy season
Personas: Owner/Manager, Office Associate

Before summer, the owner opens the dashboard to see how many customers are due for AC service, how many lawn plans are active, and how busy each crew is. The owner notices that many past customers haven't scheduled yet and has the associates send reminder messages. This fills the calendar, balances workload across services, and avoids missed revenue.

Use Case 5: Follow-up after a job
Personas: Customer, Owner/Manager

After each completed job, the CRM sends a thank-you and a request for feedback. If a customer reports a problem, the manager is alerted, reviews the technician's notes, and has someone follow up quickly. The next maintenance reminder is scheduled automatically (for example, next fall for the furnace or next spring for the garage door).

Tip: Since these three services peak at different times (HVAC in summer and winter, lawn care in spring through fall, garage doors year-round), you can point out that one CRM helps the business keep work steady and cross-sell between services. That makes a good selling point for your PRD.

I can add a short "cross-selling" use case, such as offering garage door maintenance to a lawn care customer, if you want one.

Use Case 6: Cross-selling a service to an existing customer
Personas: Customer, Office Associate, Owner/Manager

A homeowner has been on a weekly lawn care plan for two seasons but has never used the company's other services. The CRM notices that this customer has no HVAC or garage door history and flags them as a good cross-sell. In late summer, it sends them a text offering a fall furnace tune-up at a discounted rate for existing customers. The customer replies with interest, and the associate sees the message in the customer's record, confirms a time, and books the visit. The next time the customer calls, any associate can see all three services in one history. The owner can then check the dashboard to see how many customers use more than one service, which shows whether cross-selling is growing revenue.

OLD:

1. Manager/Lead - B2B Sales Lead

- Wants a CRM that automatically syncs with calendar, LinkedIn, phone, and socials - wants better lead tracking that reduces the time they have to input information
- Integration with common email providers, such as Gmail or Outlook

2. Digital/email marketing associate

- Wants custom email workflows and templates
- Wants the CRM to support A/B testing

3. Associate/users - job seeking

- Wants a CRM that provides customizable follow-up options (phone, socials, LinkedIn)
- Want a job hunting spreadsheet with rich natural language processing and filters